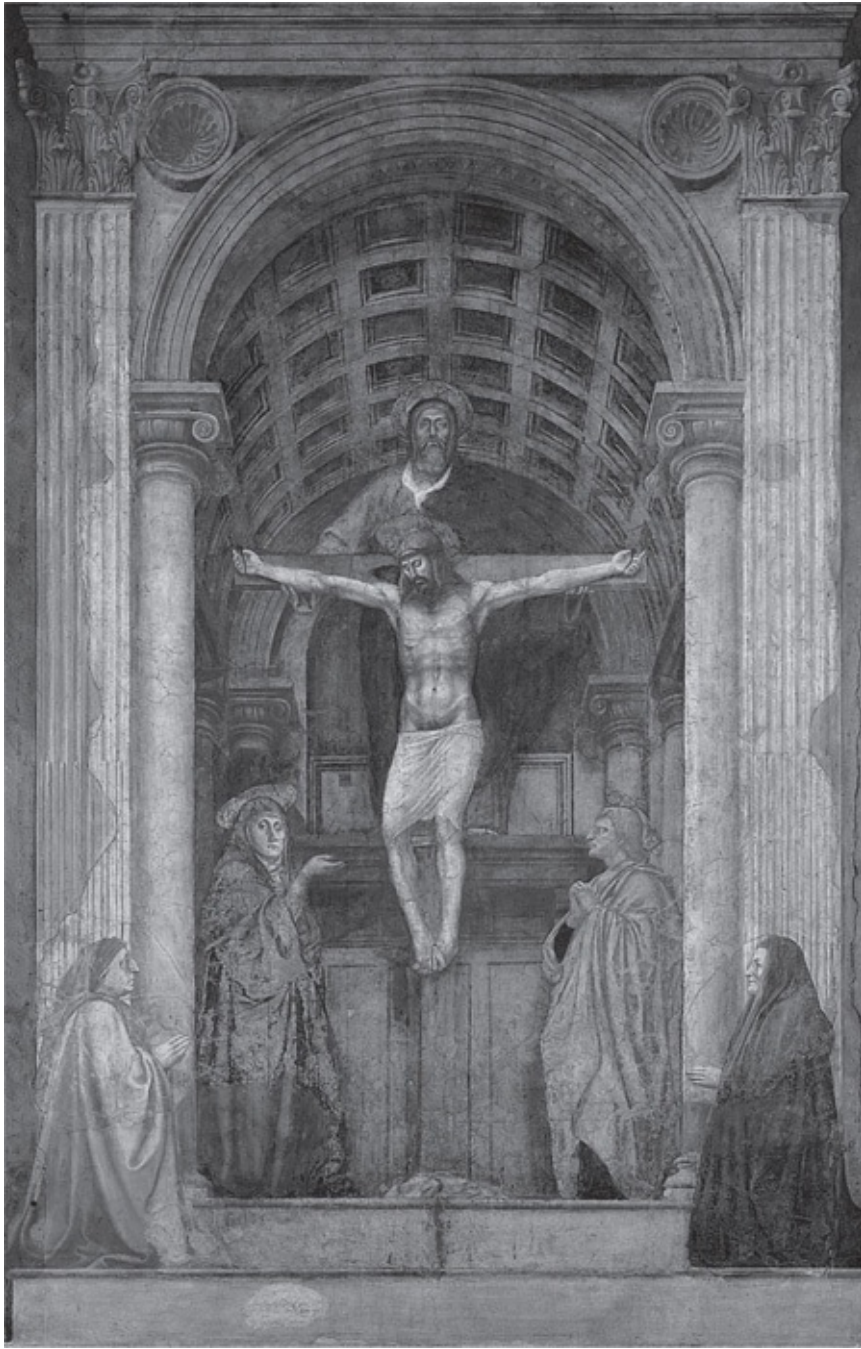


Early Renaissance

The Renaissance (French for rebirth) was a period – roughly from the 14th to the 16th century – that saw a rebirth of interest in the philosophy, literature, architecture and art of ancient Greece and Rome. Developments began in Florence and Siena when artists, scientists and philosophers rediscovered their past and simultaneously found individuality. Moving away from the notion of God's omnipresence, artists began to reflect a new interest in humanism. Related to this, they strove for accuracy, and no longer considered themselves to be anonymous craftsmen, but important, skilled individuals. Artists aimed to portray accurate proportions and lifelike human forms, clothing and expressions. In painting, figures appeared weightier, and the space they occupied was more convincingly constructed. New techniques suggested lifelike qualities, and after Florentine architect Filippo Brunelleschi (1377–1446) worked out a method of representing linear perspective on two-dimensional surfaces, flat paintings appeared particularly real. In sculpture, realism appeared in features, hair, clothing and gestures.



Masaccio, *Holy Trinity*, c.1426